

Both sides read the ground

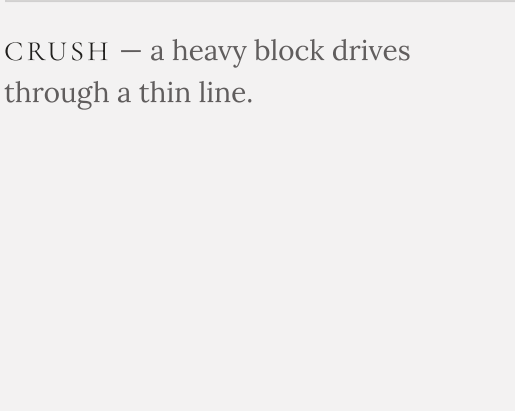
A flat, top-down plan of the showpiece animation, drawn so the geometry can be judged before it moves. Elevation is flat colour steps, not perspective. Every force is a shape, every intention an arrow, and no two shapes ever touch. This document fixes the board, the shape language, the move order and the timing; phase 2 animates exactly this.

SHAPE LANGUAGE

The three relationships, held constant across every panel. Small and fast goes around; large and heavy goes through; solid and firm absorbs and turns.



FLANK — a fast wedge sweeps around a heavy block.



CRUSH — a heavy block drives through a thin line.



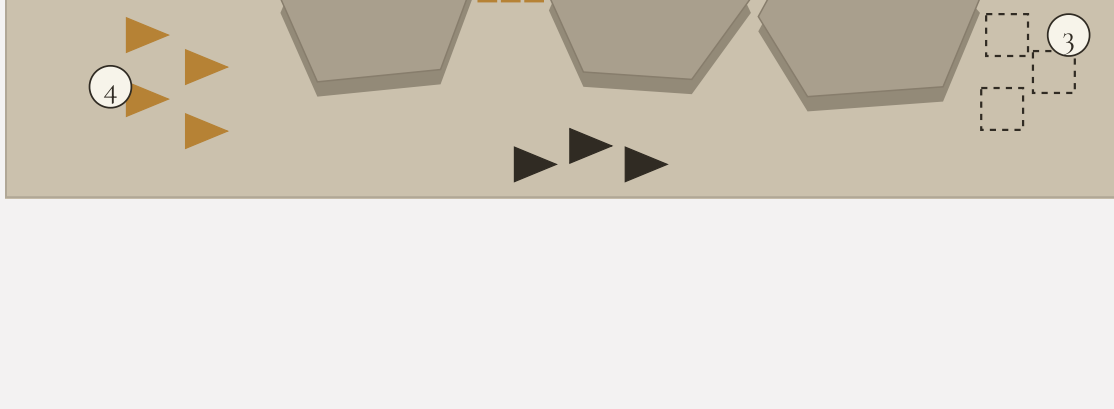
HOLD — a firm wall absorbs a wedge and turns it.

NOTATION

- Committed move
- Option considered, then dropped
- Side A — gold. Blocks are heavy, wedges are fast.
- Side B — ink. Same vocabulary, mirrored.
- A force held out of sight behind terrain
- Three elevation levels, lightest highest

THE BOARD, AT REST

Opening position, held for the first beat so the viewer can read it. Neither side is caught out: both have used the terrain. This is the frame the whole sequence returns to.

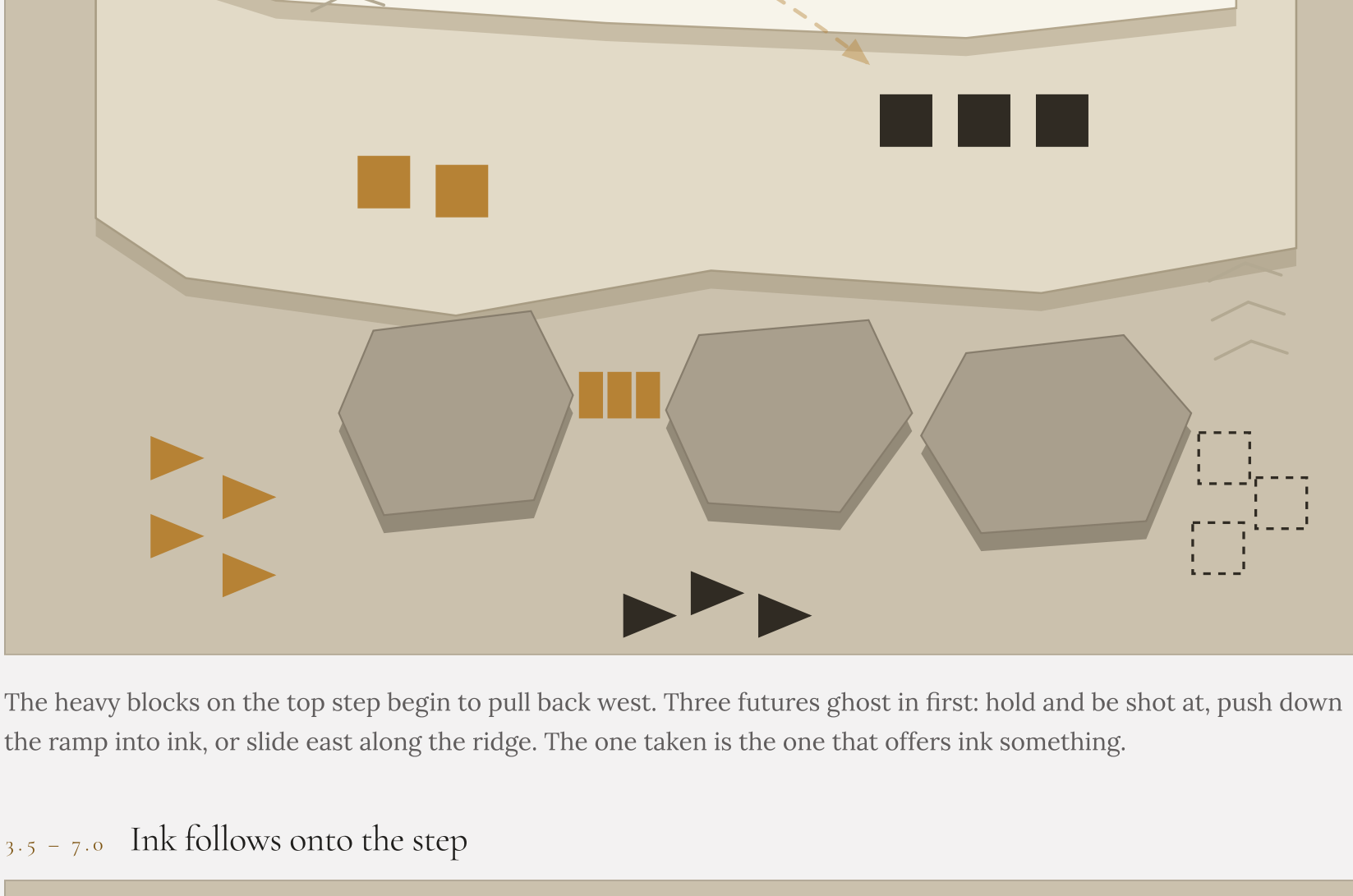


- The high level.** Gold's heavy blocks hold the top step. Height is the prize and the trap — whoever stands there can be pulled off it.
- The chokepoint.** The only northward route off the low flats, sealed by a gold wall of three firm blocks.
- The screen.** Ink's reserve waits behind the south-east rock mass, drawn hollow because it cannot be seen.
- The low ramp.** Gold's wedges sit on the lowest step by the western ramp, out of the fight and one move from anywhere.

MOVE AND ANSWER

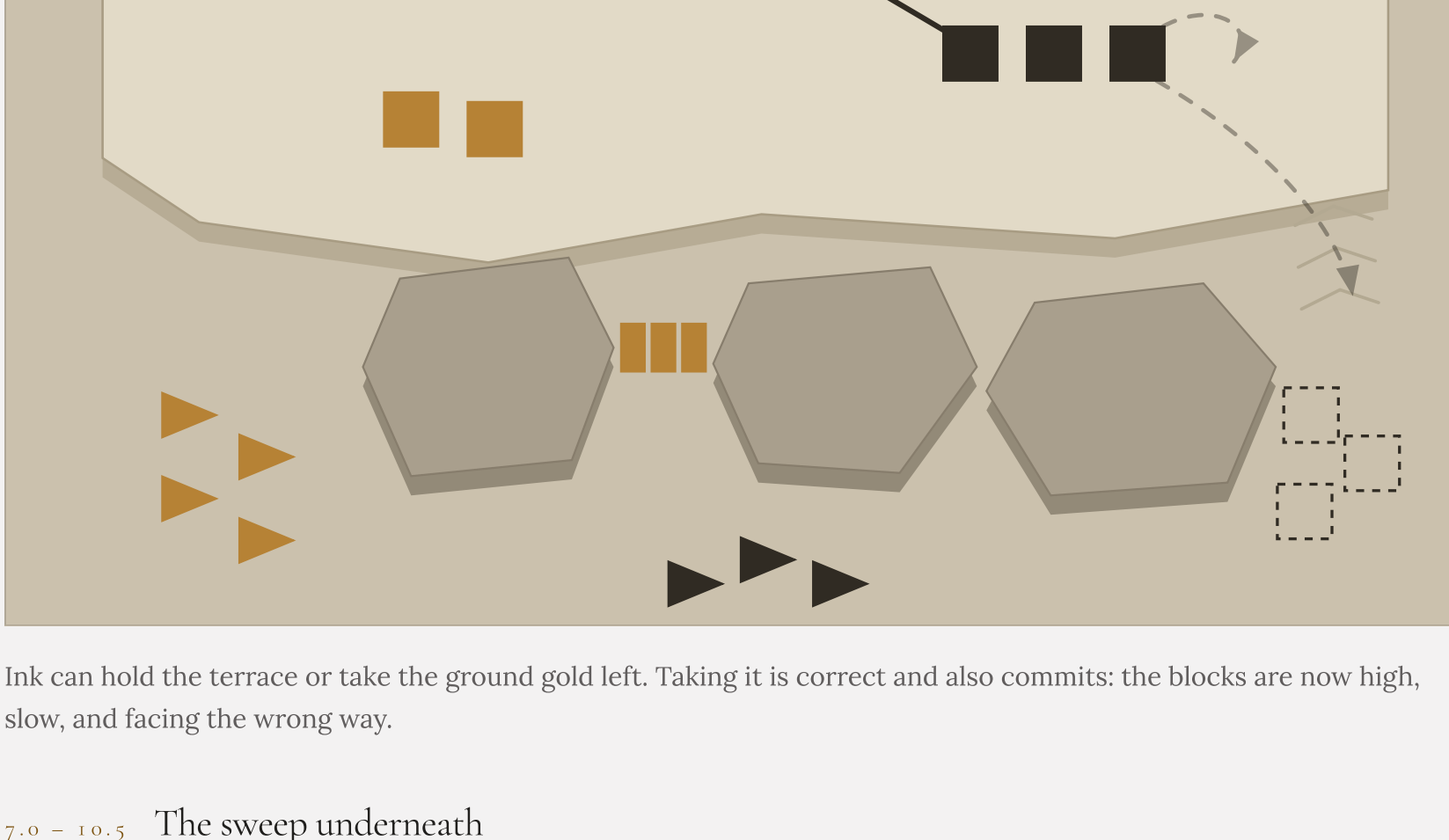
Six moves, two exchanges. Gold wins the first by pulling height away and flanking underneath; ink wins the second with a feint and a hidden reserve. At each decision point the alternatives are drawn faintly, then dropped — options first, event second.

0.0 — 3.5 Gold gives up the height



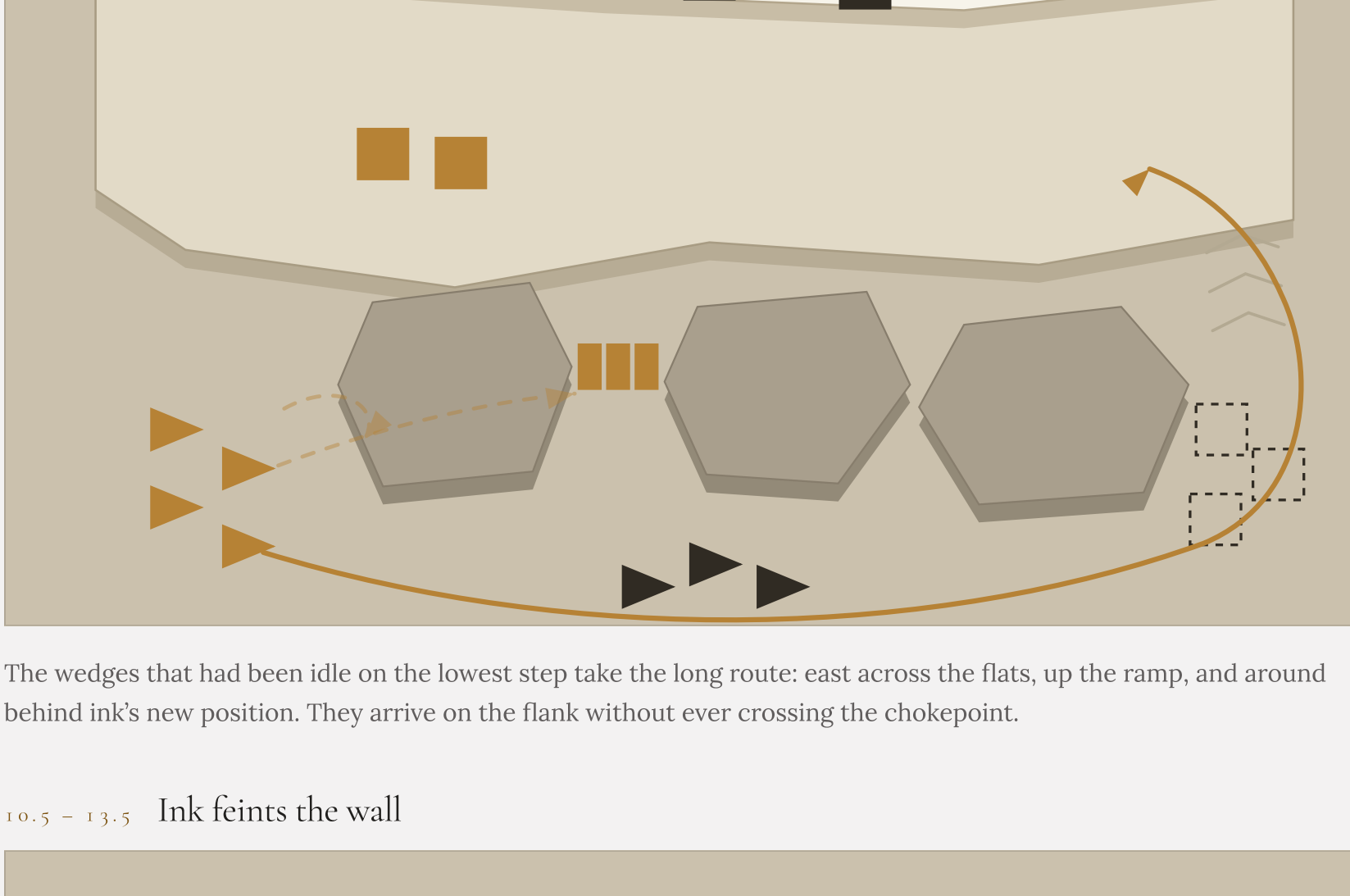
The heavy blocks on the top step begin to pull back west. Three futures ghost in first: hold and be shot at, push down the ramp into ink, or slide east along the ridge. The one taken is the one that offers ink something.

3.5 — 7.0 Ink follows onto the step



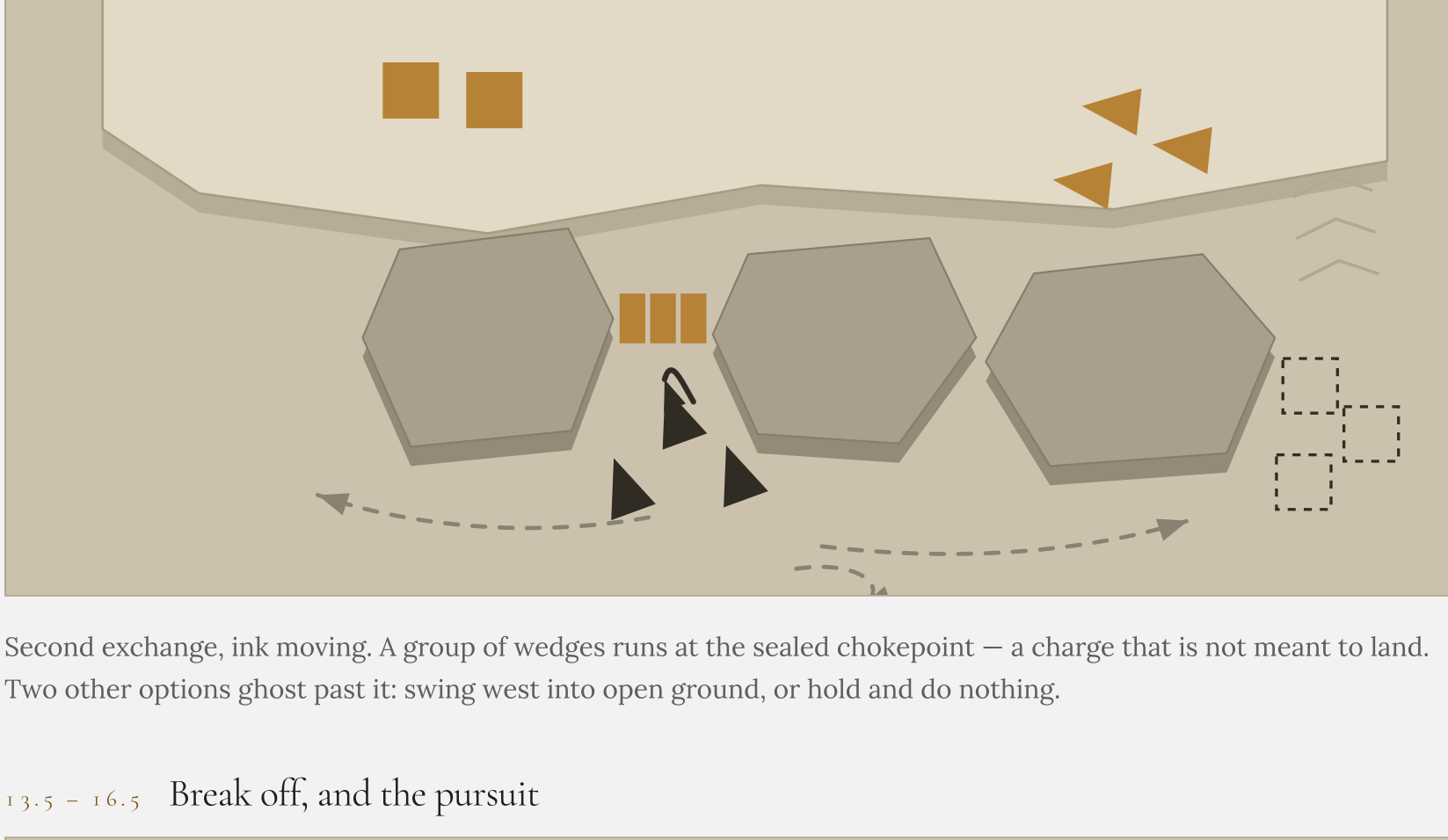
Ink can hold the terrace or take the ground gold left. Taking it is correct and also commits: the blocks are now high, slow, and facing the wrong way.

7.0 — 10.5 The sweep underneath



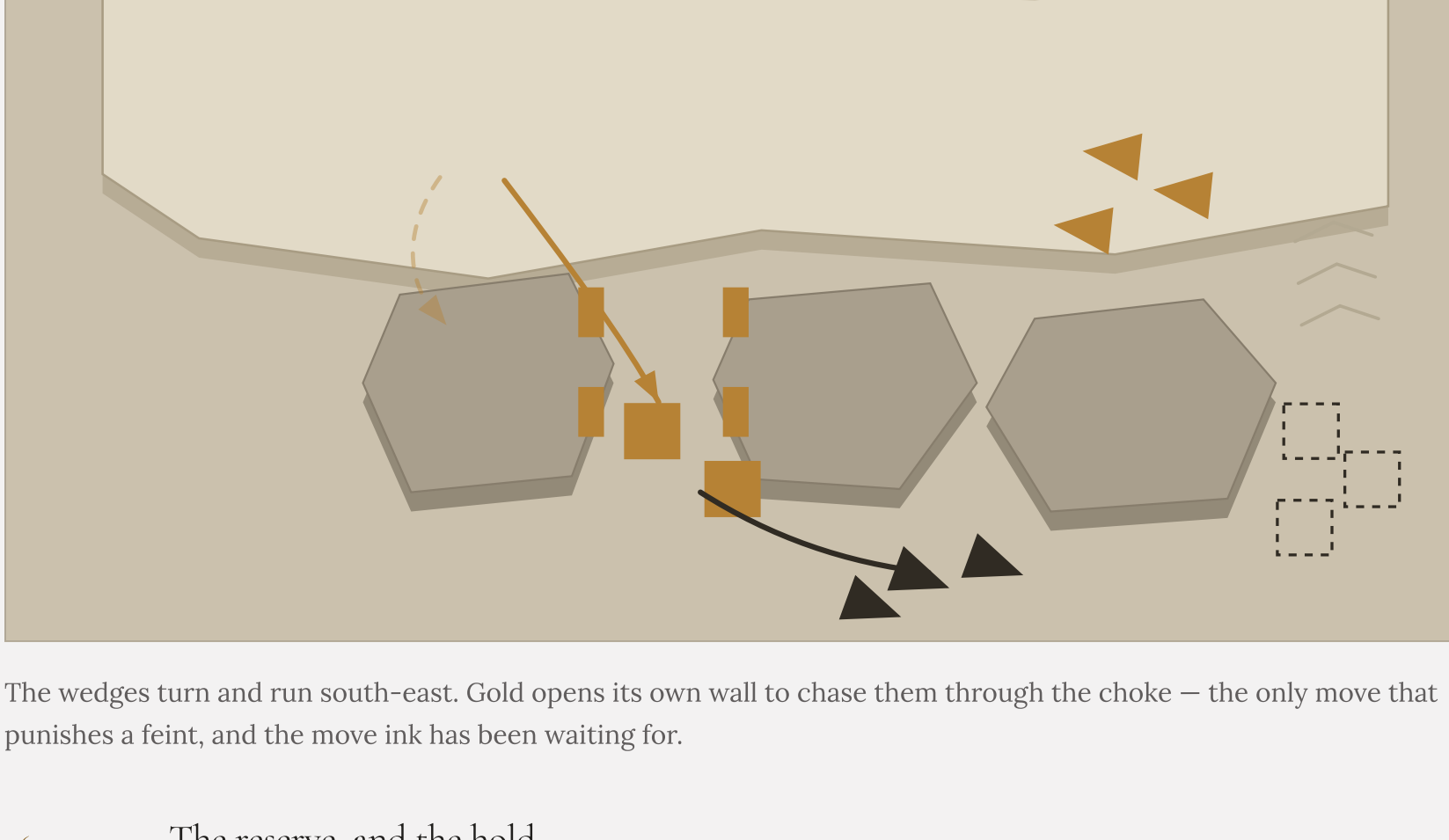
The wedges that had been idle on the lowest step take the long route: east across the flats, up the ramp, and around behind ink's new position. They arrive on the flank without ever crossing the chokepoint.

10.5 — 13.5 Ink feints the wall



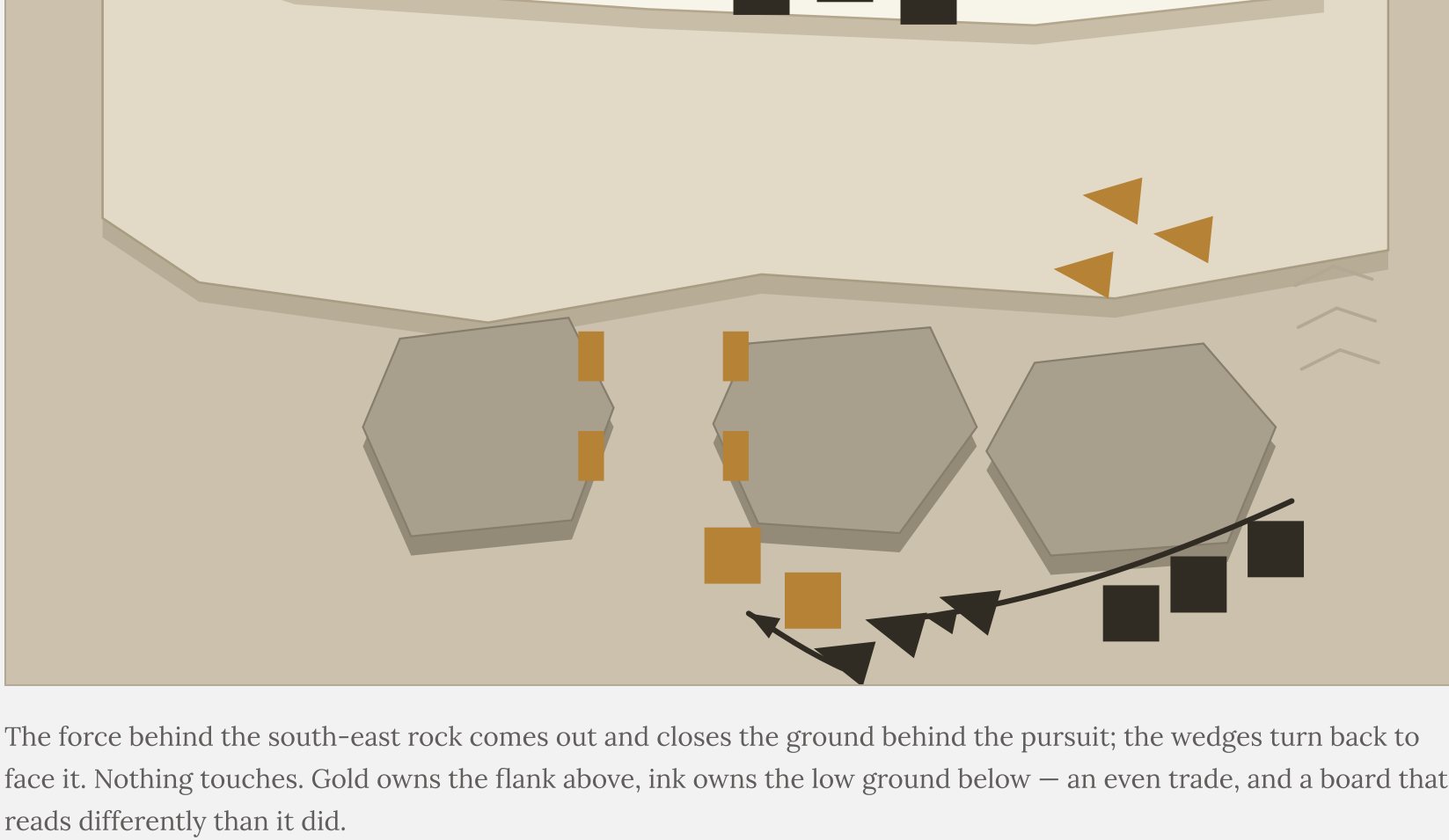
Second exchange, ink moving. A group of wedges runs at the sealed chokepoint — a charge that is not meant to land. Two other options ghost past it: swing west into open ground, or hold and do nothing.

13.5 — 16.5 Break off, and the pursuit



The wedges turn and run south-east. Gold opens its own wall to chase them through the choke — the only move that punishes a feint, and the move ink has been waiting for.

16.5 — 19.0 The reserve, and the hold



The force behind the south-east rock comes out and closes the ground behind the pursuit; the wedges turn back to face it. Nothing touches. Gold owns the flank above, ink owns the low ground below — an even trade, a changed board.

TIMING

Nineteen seconds. Each move is an arrow drawn over roughly one second, a half-second pause, then the shapes travelling. The hold at the end is as important as the moves.

0.0 — 3.5	3.5 — 7.0	7.0 — 10.5	10.5 — 13.5	13.5 — 16.5	16.5 — 19.0
Read the board · gold gives up height	Ink follows onto the step	The long sweep underneath	The feint	Break off · the pursuit	The reserve · hold

RULES FOR PHASE 2

No shape ever touches another; keep a clear gap at the closest approach. No damage, no contact, no text in frame. Camera stays overhead and still except for a slow drift; the reading is done by the shapes.

WHAT EACH ARROW DOES

Options ghost in together, hold for about a second, then two fade as one draws solid. Shapes only move after their arrow has finished drawing, and the arrow fades behind them as they travel it.

WHAT IT MUST READ AS

Thinking, not fighting. Two competent people each holding several futures at once, spending position rather than force. It ends unresolved: an even trade, a changed board.